

A field guide to Claude Cowork

Email Voice.

Teach Claude your real writing voice so every email it drafts sounds like you wrote it. Setup takes about two minutes.

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COMPANION FILE

email-voice.skill

READ TIME

4 minutes

The Problem

Ask most AI tools to draft an email and you get something like "I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to inform you that..." Nobody talks like that — including you. So you spend ten minutes rewriting it, which defeats the point of asking AI at all.

The Email Voice skill fixes that by studying your **real** sent emails instead of guessing. It builds a voice profile and applies it to every draft from then on.

THE CORE IDEA

Your sent folder already shows exactly how you write — greetings, sign-offs, favorite phrases. The skill reads 15–20 of your real sent emails, saves the pattern to a file called EMAIL-VOICE.md, and every draft after that sounds like you on a good day.

GENERIC AI

Dear Mr. Johnson, I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to inform you that I would be delighted to participate in the aforementioned project... Best regards,

YOUR VOICE

Hey Mike, I'm in! Really excited about this one. One thing: I can't start until July. Does that still work on your end? Cheers!

How It Works

First run: the skill notices it doesn't know your voice yet, pulls 15–20 real sent emails through your Gmail connector (read-only), and studies your openings, closings, sentence rhythm, and go-to phrases. It saves the result as EMAIL-VOICE.md and shows you a summary to confirm.

Every run after: paste in an email and say "draft a reply." The skill reads your voice profile, matches tone to how well you know the recipient, and checks the draft against a rulebook of AI-sounding filler so corporate-speak never sneaks back in.

WHAT IT NEVER DOES

Gmail access is read-only. The skill cannot send, delete, or change a single email. Every draft shows up in chat for you to review — you stay in control of the send button.

Setup, Step by Step

1 Install the skill

Open Claude desktop with Cowork mode on, drag in the email-voice.skill file, and click Save skill.

2 Connect Gmail

Settings → Connectors → Gmail. This is how the skill reads your sent mail to learn your voice.

3 Connect a folder

Click the folder icon in Cowork and pick any folder — your voice profile saves there between sessions.

4 Run the setup prompt

Takes about two minutes end to end.

PROMPT · LEARN MY VOICE

Set up my email voice.

Using It Every Day

PROMPT · DRAFT A REPLY

Draft a reply to this email. I know this person well, and the main thing I want to say is that I'm in for the project but I can't start until July.

More context in, better draft out — but even a bare "reply to this and say yes" comes back in your voice. If your style shifts over time, refresh it anytime:

PROMPT · REFRESH YOUR VOICE

Update my email voice.

No Gmail? Paste in 10–20 old sent emails instead — a mix of casual and formal. The skill learns from whatever you give it.

Tools You'll Need

email-voice.skill *Included with this download*

Drag into Cowork, click Save skill, done.

Claude desktop app *Cowork mode on*

Where the skill runs and drafts show up.

Gmail connector *Free · Settings → Connectors*

Read-only — lets the skill learn your voice, never sends.

Do This Today

- 01 Install the skill and connect Gmail.
 - 02 Run the setup prompt and review what it learns about you.
 - 03 Draft one real reply with it — give yourself back the ten minutes.
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